10. That Sinking Feeling

Full story and 100% mission walkthrough

True Believer target: 90,000 studs.

Completion requirements: finish the story, achieve True Believer, collect all 10 minikits and rescue Stan Lee. These award four Gold Bricks in total: one for each requirement, with one brick for the complete minikit set. All ten minikits also complete this level's comic.

Before you begin

This guide covers the original LEGO Marvel Super Heroes console/PC campaign. Play the story route first, then return in Free Play for a complete collection run. Finish the campaign and unlock or purchase the additional characters you need before attempting every detour. The numbered minikits below identify this guide's route, not a separate numbering system shown by the game.

Free Play characters and abilities: Iron Man Mark 42, Thor and Spider-Man cover the main route. Add Wolverine for claw switches and digging, Captain America for the shield switch, Magneto for Stan's restraint, Jean Grey for telekinesis and Sandman for the underwater passage.

Route warning: Use the opening terminal and salvage-crane generator twice. The first use of each advances the story; the second use opens a collectible route. Finish all tanker tasks before the underwater transition.

Reaching True Believer

Thoroughly clear the tanker before M.O.D.O.K., including the upper walkway and mini-sub detour. The seabed has fewer ordinary smashable furnishings, so arrive there with a strong total rather than depending entirely on the final stretch.

You need 90,000 studs in a single visit to this mission; totals from separate attempts do not add together. Smash scenery, follow stud trails and recover dropped studs promptly after a death. Enabled stud-multiplier extras count towards the meter: with only x2 active, 45,000 ordinary stud value reaches this target. Check that the True Believer banner has appeared before ending or saving your run. You can earn it in Story Mode or Free Play.

Full story route

Team: Iron Man Mark 42, Thor and Spider-Man; Jean Grey supports the underwater section

Goal: Recover the research submarine, defeat M.O.D.O.K. and cross the seabed.

1. Reach the tanker

Leave the Helicarrier and fly toward the mission marker offshore. The destination is the research submarine, but Doctor Doom's tanker captures it before the team arrives. Spider-Man joins Iron Man and Thor for the boarding operation. Follow the story marker rather than searching Manhattan for a street entrance.

Inside, defeat the A.I.M. agents and break the objects beside the bank of monitors. Build the console and use Iron Man to rotate the circuit pieces into a complete connection. The water system extinguishes the fire at the golden wall. Cut through that wall with Mark 42's heat beam.

Spider-Man reveals the climbing wall beyond, climbs to the upper walkway and uses his senses again to find the pipe's web handles. Pull them to send water into the next section. Return to the lower door, reveal and pull its handles to release the water over the fire. Break the now-safe objects, build an electrical transformer and charge it with Thor to open the door.

2. Operate the salvage crane and mini-sub

Fight through the corridor and continue to the small boat on the right. Iron Man explodes the silver crates; Thor charges the exposed electrical device to move the crane's container into position.

Use Spider-Sense to reveal the container's handles and pull it open. Build the dropped pieces into a console and operate it with Iron Man. You now control a small underwater submarine. Steer it into both red buttons to deploy the bridge. Adjust its depth as well as its horizontal position; passing over a button will not necessarily activate it.

Cross the bridge and melt the gold container. Build another transformer, charge it with Thor and take the route opened by the overloaded generator. Follow the walkway toward the research sub and M.O.D.O.K.'s circular arena.

If the crane puzzle stalls, check each handoff: missiles expose the electrical device, lightning moves the container, senses reveal handles, and the handles supply the console. None of those stages can be skipped by continuing to attack the boat.

3. Defeat M.O.D.O.K.

M.O.D.O.K.'s shield prevents damage at the start. Deal with the nearby agents and wait for his attack to expose him. When the shield drops, use a targeted ranged hit; Thor's thrown hammer is a dependable choice. Avoid the ensuing area attack and move in when the boss drops down, then strike him at close range.

Repeat the opening and follow-up twice more. Watch the shield rather than wasting a stream of shots while it is active. The ranged attack creates the stun, but the grounded melee attack delivers the meaningful damage.

After the third successful cycle, the story moves below the surface. Jean Grey provides an air bubble for the group; she supports this sequence rather than becoming a normal selectable member of the team. Stay on the protected route with the others.

4. Open the underwater wreckage

Break the debris to the left of the large hatch and use Thor on the revealed cracks. Assemble the released pieces into the starfish-shaped hatch mechanism. Spider-Sense reveals its handles; pull them and defeat the Doombots emerging from the opening.

Follow the route through the wreck and around to the ancient ruins. Spider-Man reveals and pulls the front attachments, exposing cracks for Thor's hammer. At the next fallen statue, Iron Man destroys the silver plate and Thor breaks the stone underneath.

A tentacle holds the final pillar upright. Melt all four golden links with Iron Man's heat beam, then use Spider-Sense and pull the revealed handles to lower the pillar into a bridge. Cross, clear the Doombots and have Thor smash the cracked section of the research submarine's hull. That final opening completes the level.

Complete Free Play collection route

Follow these entries alongside the story route above. Complete each area's detours before taking its exit. For a challenge involving several objects, start at the first listed location and finish the whole set in the same replay. A challenge's reward may appear later than another numbered minikit.

Minikit 1: Opening room: reuse the sprinkler console

After the story sprinkler puts out the first fire, use its console again. Select the left arrow to move the hose fully left, then activate the central control to spray. Collect the minikit from the extinguished fire along the left wall.

Minikit 2: Opening room: claw switch

To the right of the gold wall, activate the claw switch with Wolverine. Let the M.O.D.O.K. display finish appearing and collect the minikit it releases.

Stan Lee in Peril

After cutting the first gold wall and climbing Spider-Man's wall, follow the upper walkway around to the right. Stan is pinned beneath blue metal near the water-pipe puzzle. Lift the restraint with Magneto and wait for the rescue notification before descending.

Minikit 3: Tanker: three Doom holograms

Destroy the projector at the bottom of the opening room's stairs, the one near the green machinery/mini-sub console in the next area, and the one by the passage leading to M.O.D.O.K. The third destroyed projector awards the minikit.

Minikit 4: Connecting corridor: shield switch

In the enemy-filled passage between the tanker rooms, find the Captain America switch on the wall. Throw his shield into it and collect the minikit before proceeding to the salvage machinery.

Minikit 5: Salvage crane: second container

After raising the container that supplies the mini-sub console, charge the boat's electrical unit again with Thor. The crane retrieves another container. Melt its gold side with Mark 42 and take the minikit.

Minikit 6: Mini-sub: submerged collectible

While controlling the little remote submarine, descend between the two underwater red switches. Steer through the minikit between the columns. Adjust depth as well as left/right position, then finish the switches to continue the story.

Minikit 7: Seabed: three buried chests

Dig at the right of the starting wreck, beside the large ancient gateway farther along, and near the final submarine hull, left of its cracked entrance. Open or smash each excavated chest. Complete all three before breaking through the final story wall.

Minikit 8: Ancient archway: sand passage

After destroying the large underwater arch, smash the remaining right-hand pillar. Use Sandman on the sand sculpture it exposes. He travels into the elevated recess holding the minikit. Use the sand route again to return to the seabed.

Minikit 9: Shipwreck: purple worm

Near the sand passage, find the purple-highlighted object sticking out of the wreck above. Pull it with Jean Grey's telekinesis. Wait for the fish to take the worm, then pick up the minikit it leaves below.

Minikit 10: Seabed: right-hand fork

On the final approach towards the sunken research submarine, the main path rises to the left. Take the short right-hand branch instead and look behind the rock at the edge. Walk into the visible minikit, then return to the main route.

Final completion check

Before the final boss hit or exit, confirm 10/10 minikits and the Stan Lee rescue message. Confirm the 90,000-stud True Believer target has registered, either on this run or an earlier saved run. Finish the mission if you still need its story-completion Gold Brick.

If the story is already complete, use the pause menu's exit/return option and choose Save and Exit to keep new collectibles. Wait for saving to finish. Previously collected minikits are replaced by studs on later visits, so check the saved counter instead of expecting every canister to remain visible. If a multi-object challenge is incomplete, finish it before leaving.

These checks complete this story mission. There are no Deadpool red bricks or separate Free Play character-token hunts in these 15 main story levels. Bonus missions, Manhattan activities, character purchases and other hub collectibles are separate requirements for 100% of the entire game.